IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE "E"

The Canyon Lake Public Safety and Emergency Response Protection Measure (Measure "E") was placed on the ballot by a petition signed by the requisite number of voters. If approved by a majority of Canyon Lake voters voting on Measure E, the Measure would authorize a one percent (1%) special transactions and use (sales) tax and establish restrictions governing the receipt and expenditure of specified City revenues. A one percent (1%) rate equates to an extra 1¢ per $1 purchased of taxable goods. Exempted from sales tax are unprocessed groceries, rent, prescription medicine and personal services such as medical, dental, and legal. It is estimated that Measure "E" will provide an additional $1,140,000 in annual local funding. Because the revenues are restricted to specified purposes, the Measure would impose a special tax.

The Measure would create a separate Canyon Lake Public Safety Fund. All revenues from the new tax would be deposited into the Public Safety Fund and could not be commingled with the City's General Fund. The Measure also requires specified existing City revenues to be deposited into the Fund, including EMS Subscription Program revenues, property-tax revenues received from Riverside County for fire protection, the City's Utility Users Tax dedicated to police, fire, and paramedic services, and related investment earnings.

Public Safety Fund revenues could be used only for specified public-safety purposes, including compensation and benefits for sworn police, fire, and paramedic personnel, related equipment and training, and EMS program costs. The Measure prohibits interfund loans or transfers from the Public Safety Fund, pledging Public Safety Fund revenues for City debt, and land acquisition and capital projects, except as strictly necessary for the direct operational support of sworn public-safety services.

The Measure requires an annual independent financial audit and public review at least every four years. It also authorizes Canyon Lake residents or qualified electors to bring civil actions to enforce its provisions. The Measure would remain in effect unless repealed by a majority of Canyon Lake voters at a subsequent election.

A "yes" vote will adopt the Measure and authorize the 1% transactions and use tax and related Public Safety Fund requirements.

A "no" vote will not adopt the Measure.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of the Canyon Lake Public Safety and Emergency Response Protection Measure. If you desire a copy of the Ordinance, please call the City Clerk at 951-244-2955 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you.

By: Dated August 17, 2026

Steven Graham Pacifico,
City Attorney

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE "E"

Yes on Measure E

The truth of what a city is: the entity that provides residents and businesses protection. You find truth in that statement when you realize the vast majority of every city's budget is public safety: Police and Fire.

Voting Yes on Measure E pays our firefighters and police officers. It helps us find and retain the best talent. Every cent of it. What we should also understand is that Measure E is bigger than just Fire and Police. It's about the sustainability of our city.

Everything you and I buy now costs more, but for most of us, our incomes have stayed the same. The same is true for our city.

We expect a lot from Canyon Lake because of how we view it and ourselves. The reality is, if we stayed with Cal Fire or RSO, we would have already needed to cut services. The reality we also need to grasp is that everything else the city buys and provides outside of Police and Fire is also more expensive. This measure allows our city to pay for public safety and still function in the manner we expect everywhere else.

For those who are concerned about paying the extra penny for every dollar they spend in Canyon Lake, I say you're already paying it, and you're paying more. Every city surrounding Canyon Lake has this proposed tax rate.

When you buy at the shopping centers in Menifee, you're paying it. When you shop at Costco or other businesses in Lake Elsinore, you're paying it. How much do we spend in those business complexes compared to our little city? You're already paying, and paying more — just to those other cities.

Now our city needs this and you.

Vote Yes on Measure E.

By: Damon Smith

NO ARGUMENT FILED AGAINST MEASURE "E"